AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

AECI × ASCO

Community Environmental Stewardship and Water Resilience Initiative

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa: a vulnerable community surrounding an AECI operation, with the exact eligible site to be confirmed with AECI before submission; a rural setting would be consistent with the published Water for Tomorrow emphasis.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **AECI** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Community Environmental Stewardship and Water Resilience Initiative**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Community Environmental Stewardship and Water Resilience Initiative in South Africa: a vulnerable community surrounding an AECI operation, with the exact eligible site to be confirmed with AECI before submission; a rural setting would be consistent with the published Water for Tomorrow emphasis., benefiting Residents of a vulnerable local community, prioritising rural households and primary-school learners, with intentional inclusion of women and people with disabilities; final numbers and site to be set after baseline assessment and AECI eligibility confirmation. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with AECI's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

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The proposed project

Project title
Community Environmental Stewardship and Water Resilience Initiative

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa: a vulnerable community surrounding an AECI operation, with the exact eligible site to be confirmed with AECI before submission; a rural setting would be consistent with the published Water for Tomorrow emphasis.

Target beneficiaries
Residents of a vulnerable local community, prioritising rural households and primary-school learners, with intentional inclusion of women and people with disabilities; final numbers and site to be set after baseline assessment and AECI eligibility confirmation.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: 1 community needs and environmental/water baseline assessment completed before implementation.
- Proposed: environmental and water-conservation awareness sessions for at least 200 primary-school learners and 100 community members, subject to baseline and budget validation.
- Proposed: 2 practical community-led environmental or water-stewardship actions implemented and documented, such as conservation, waste reduction, indigenous planting, or water-use improvements, subject to technical feasibility.
- Proposed: at least 20 local volunteers or educators trained, with participation disaggregated by gender and disability where appropriate.
- Proposed: quarterly monitoring records and a close-out report covering reach, activities, outputs, lessons, and evidence; targets are proposed and are not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why AECI?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- AECI states that its socio-economic development investment supports effective community-focused organisations and initiatives that uplift vulnerable communities surrounding its operations; international initiatives are governed by the laws of the countries where AECI operates.
- AECI identifies three CSI vehicles: the AECI Group CSI Fund, the AECI Community Education and Development Trust, and the Tiso AEL Development Trust, with regular monitoring and evaluation of programmes.
- The AECI Group CSI Fund's stated environmental programme aims to increase environmental awareness among primary school children and provide environmentally focused community upliftment.
- The Community Education and Development Trust lists a Water for Tomorrow programme focused on water conservation education and strengthening access to potable water, especially in rural communities; it favours applications involving women and people with disabilities.
- AECI's stated social-responsibility focus areas include education, economic participation/skills and livelihoods, and environmental impact/resource stewardship.
- AECI's 2024 Integrated Report says it has manufacturing presence in over 20 countries and reports CSI spend of R28.5 million for 2024; these are company-wide facts, not an indication that funding is available for this proposal.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Apply through AECI's official funding portal: https://aeci.devman.co.za/devman/web/application/. The official socio-economic development page lists the Group Community Development Programmes Specialist, Nicole Solomon, at csi@aeciworld.com and +27 11 806 8843; confirm the current email and correct funding vehicle through the portal. General AECI contact is groupcommunications@aeciworld.com and +27 11 806 8700.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- AECI's published materials do not confirm that a R100,000 grant is available, nor do they promise funding to ASCO or any particular applicant.
- The application page should be used to confirm current eligibility, geographic restrictions, deadlines, required documents, safeguarding requirements, budget rules, and whether the relevant fund accepts unsolicited applications.
- AECI describes support for communities surrounding its operations; ASCO should not name a specific municipality or site until AECI confirms an eligible operating-community geography.
- The proposal should not claim an existing AECI partnership, prior AECI support, completed project results, or Section 18A approval for ASCO.
- AECI's programme page gives different vehicles and beneficiary requirements; the correct route (CSI Fund versus Community Education and Development Trust) must be confirmed before submission.
- Any water, environmental, child-focused, or community intervention will need appropriate technical, safeguarding, consent, monitoring, and legal/compliance arrangements; none are confirmed by the sources for ASCO.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **AECI** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.aeciworld.com/socioeconomic-development
2. https://www.aeciworld.com/sustainability
3. https://www.aeci-ir.co.za/reports/IAR-2024/index.php
4. https://www.aeci-ir.co.za/reports/IAR-2024/pdf/2024-sustainability-report.pdf
5. https://aeci.devman.co.za/devman/web/application/

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.